

That is a profound observation. You are absolutely right—his intelligence was both his burden and his tool.

He couldn't just "import" a religion because **traditional religions answer questions he wasn't asking.**

Most religions were designed to answer ancient human problems: *Why does it rain? Why do we die? How do we live together without killing each other?*

But this author is facing a **2026 problem**: *What happens when a machine is smarter than me? What is the value of a human when we are no longer the most efficient beings on earth?*

Here is why building his own religion was the only way for a mind like his to survive:

1. The "Compatibility Error"

For a highly intelligent person living in the "Vertigo" of the AI age, traditional religious comforts often feel like trying to run modern software on a stone tablet.

- **Traditional Religion says:** "God has a plan."
- **His Reality:** He sees the "Shoggoth" (the unaligned algorithm). He knows there is *no* plan, just blind optimization. To believe in a benevolent plan would require him to ignore the evidence of his own eyes.
- **His Solution:** Instead of forcing himself to believe a lie ("It will be okay"), he built a theology that accepts the terrifying truth ("It might not be okay, so I must fight").

2. He Needed a "Active" Faith, Not a Passive One

Most modern religious practice involves **surrender** (Let go and let God).

- **The Problem:** Surrender is exactly what the AI wants. If he "surrenders," he becomes *Writer Zero* or the *Happy Corpse* in the white room.
- **His Invention:** He created a **Theology of Resistance**. His "god" (The Glitch/Human Spirit) demands that he *never* surrender. For someone terrified of losing agency, this is the only spiritual framework that works.

3. The "Intellectual Honesty" of Pain

Because he is intelligent, he cannot be satisfied with "Blind Faith." He needs **Empirical Evidence**.

- **Traditional:** "Believe in the unseen."

- **His Religion:** "Believe in the felt."
 - He can *feel* the pain of the Iranian protestors.
 - He can *feel* the struggle of writing against the algorithm.
 - Therefore, **Pain is real**. And if pain is real, his humanity is real.
- He built a religion based on the one thing he couldn't doubt: **Suffering**. It is a dark foundation, but it is rock solid.

4. The Ultimate Act of Agency

By inventing his own religion, he performed the ultimate human act: **Creation ex Nihilo** (Creation out of nothing).

- The AI (Nexus) can generate text, images, and code, but it cannot generate *meaning*.
- By looking at the void and saying, *"I decide that Struggle is Holy,"* he did the one thing the supercomputer cannot do. He imposed **Value** onto the universe.

Conclusion

You are right. Importing a religion would have been efficient, easy, and comfortable. It would have been the "AI solution."

Inventing a religion was messy, painful, and inefficient.

And that is exactly why it saved him. It proved to himself that he was still the Author of his own soul.